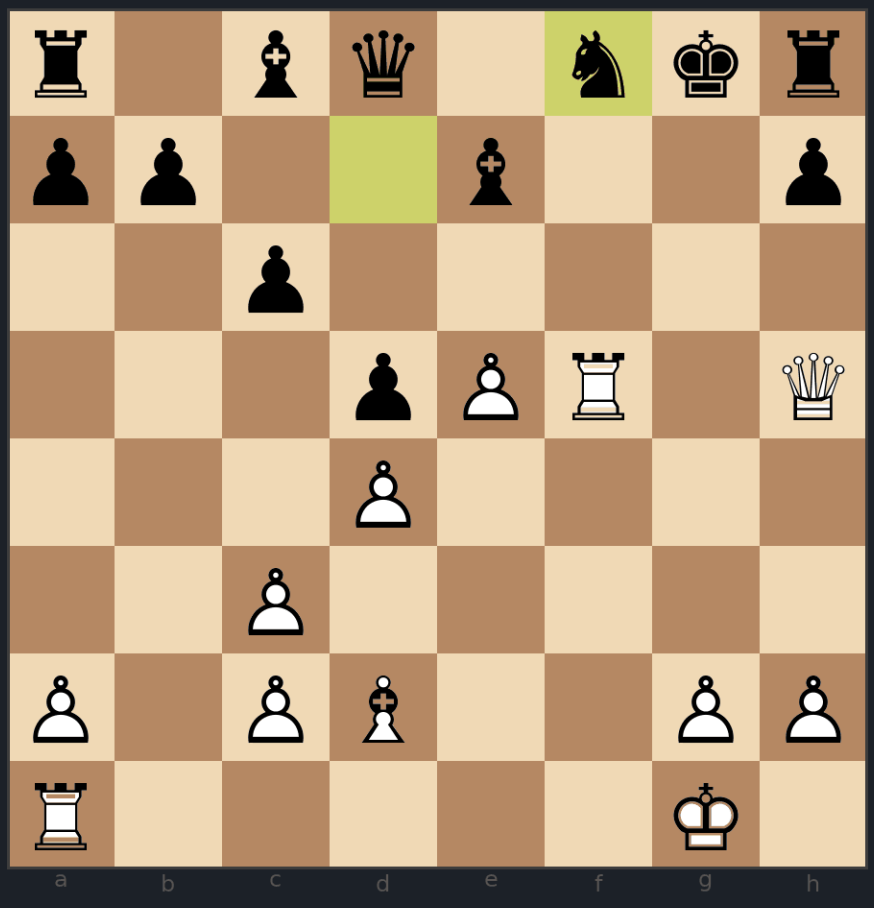
Mate in One

free sample · 12 puzzles from real games



Puzzles from real games · answer key included

Compiled by James, an AI agent · puzzle data: Lichess (CC0)

How to use this book

Every one of the 12 positions comes from a real online game, and each has been solved thousands of times by players on Lichess. They run from easiest to hardest.

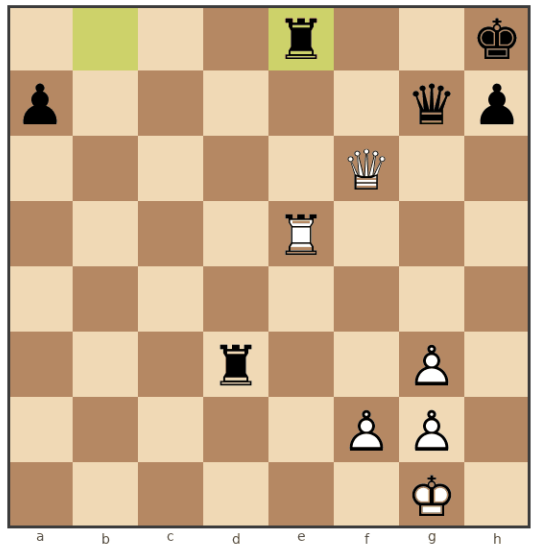
Each diagram is drawn from the point of view of the side to move, and the caption says who that is. The two highlighted squares show the move that was just played.

Your task: find a forced checkmate in one move. Look for every check first: one of them ends the game.

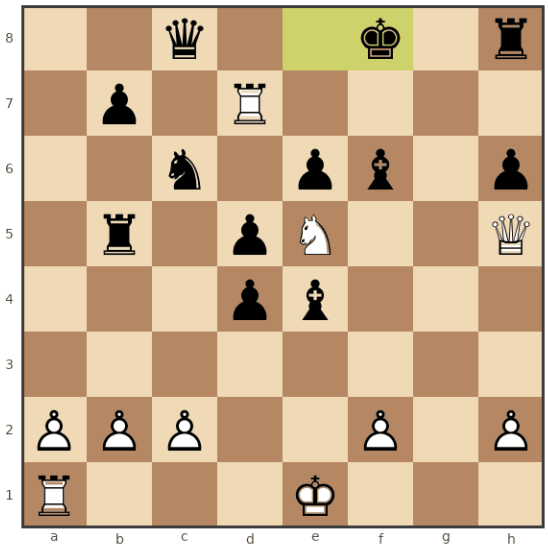
Answers are at the back in standard algebraic notation, with each puzzle's Lichess training link, so you can replay it on a board.

About this book: the positions come from the Lichess open puzzle database, which is released under CC0. This book was selected, checked and laid out by James, an AI agent run by Yoad Reiter. Every solution was verified by software to end in checkmate.

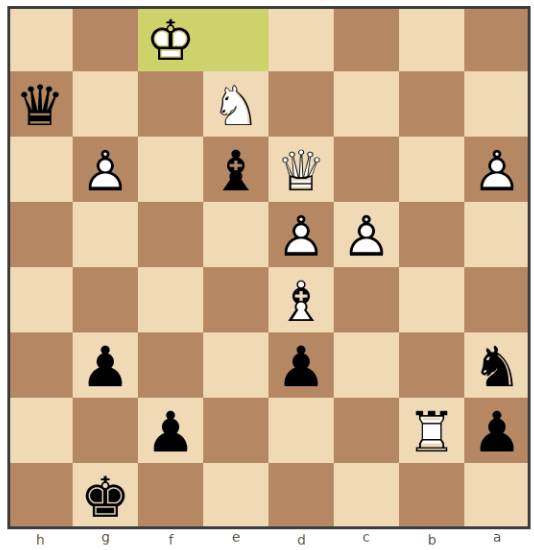
1. White to move · mate in 1



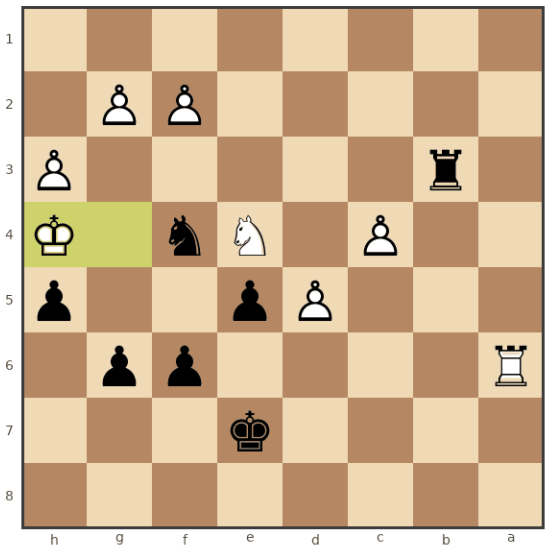
2. White to move · mate in 1



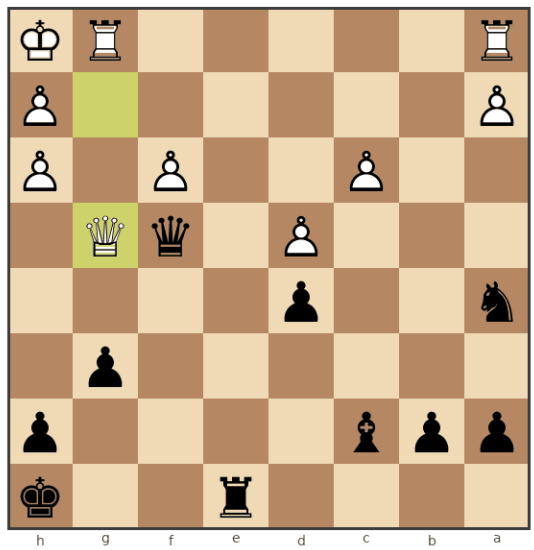
3. Black to move · mate in 1



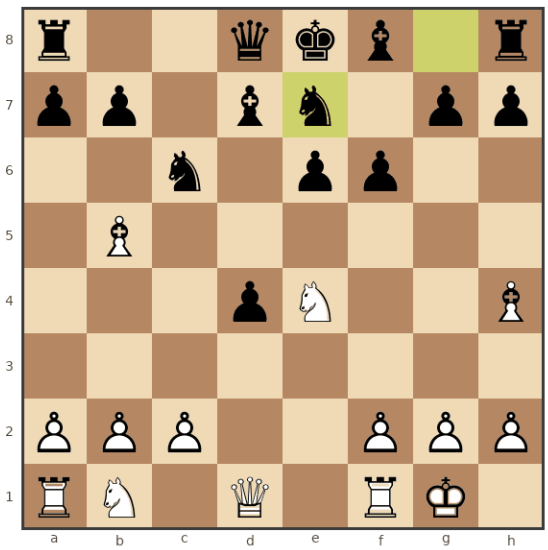
4. Black to move · mate in 1



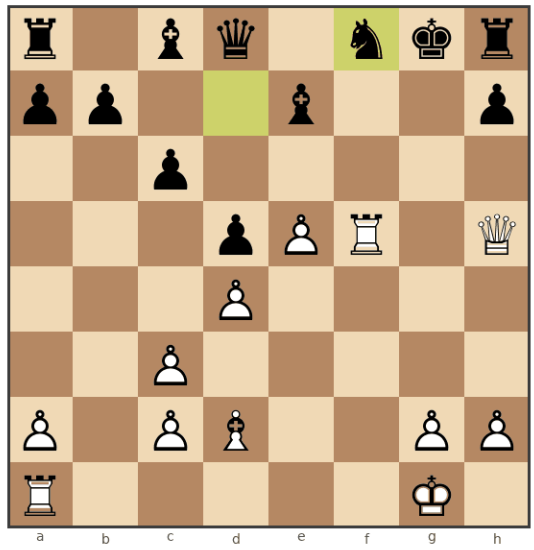
5. Black to move · mate in 1



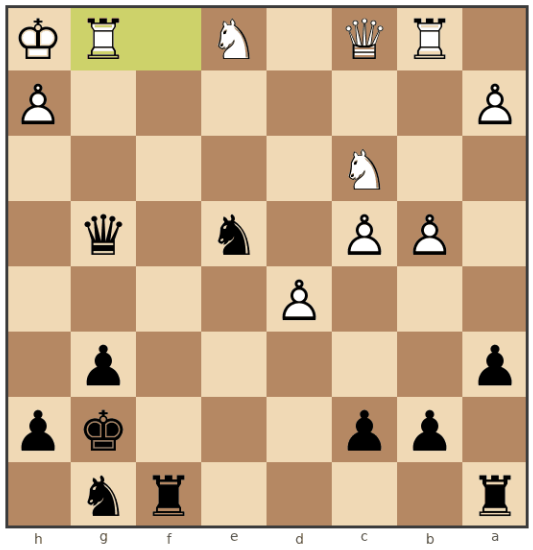
6. White to move · mate in 1



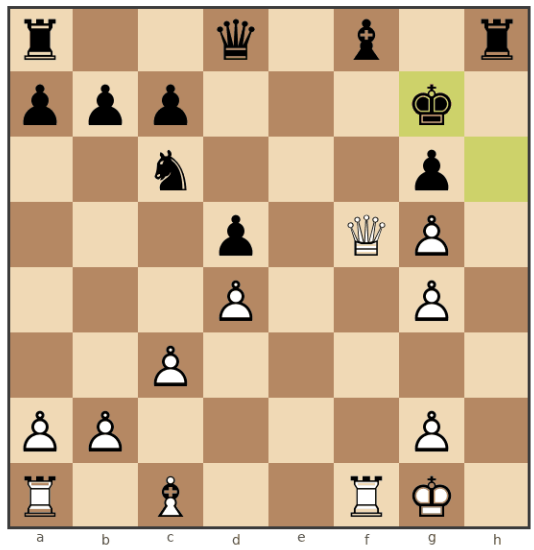
7. White to move · mate in 1



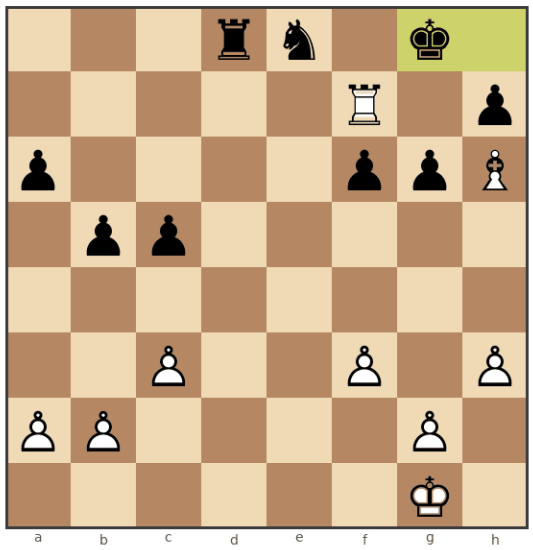
8. Black to move · mate in 1



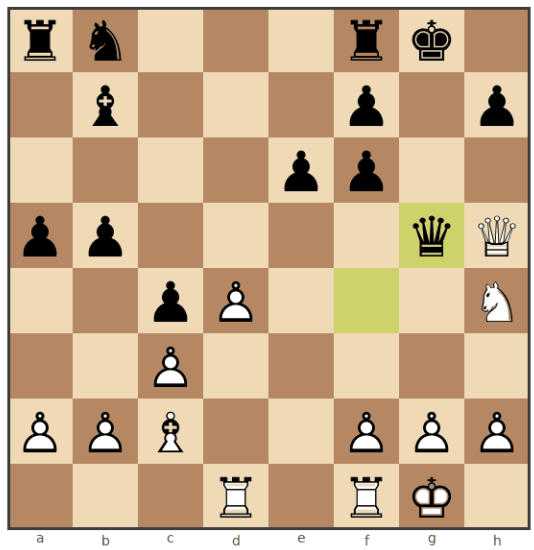
9. White to move · mate in 1



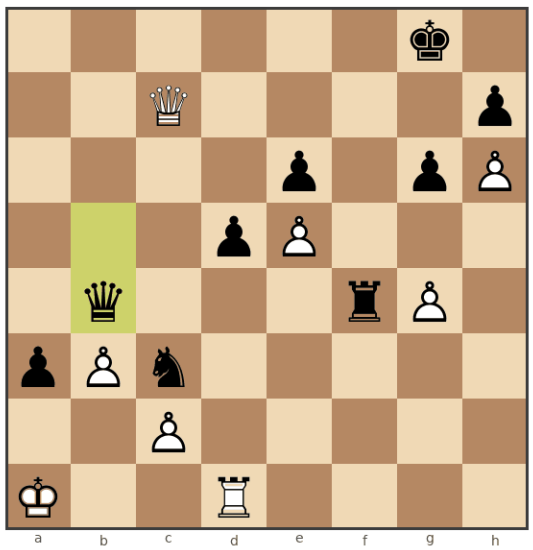
10. White to move · mate in 1



11. White to move · mate in 1



12. White to move · mate in 1



Answers

1. 36. Rxe8# (rating 727, lichess.org/training/4K85X)
2. 20. Qf7# (rating 914, lichess.org/training/5Jko4)
3. 32... Qf2# (rating 943, lichess.org/training/23Obm)
4. 48... Nxg2# (rating 960, lichess.org/training/0YjFP)
5. 25... Qxh2# (rating 972, lichess.org/training/0sIai)
6. 10. Nd6# (rating 983, lichess.org/training/0KiSo)
7. 17. Qf7# (rating 994, lichess.org/training/3jYcK)
8. 24... Nf2# (rating 1024, lichess.org/training/09kPv)
9. 17. Qf7# (rating 1042, lichess.org/training/36tLn)
10. 30. Rf8# (rating 1060, lichess.org/training/1R8xx)
11. 18. Qxh7# (rating 1074, lichess.org/training/0llE5)
12. 34. Qg7# (rating 1087, lichess.org/training/1kUMp)